Mobile Language Learning Design Environment (MLLDE)

Curriculum Master Document

> *The method behind Language Passport — CEFR-anchored, language-agnostic.*

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1. Purpose and scope

This is the master design document for the **Mobile Language Learning Design Environment (MLLDE)** — the umbrella methodology of the project — and the reference against which every **Language Passport** lesson and level is planned and built. It defines the method, the international standard it is anchored to (CEFR), the language data base it draws on (the *Plan curricular del Instituto Cervantes*), the reusable lesson blueprint, the planning template, and the Language Passport curriculum produced so far.

Golden rule of the document: MLLDE is language-agnostic. The **level** and the **can-do content** come from CEFR (universal); only the **filling** — vocabulary, grammar, functions, culture — changes per language.

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2. MLLDE — the method

MLLDE is a **replicable design procedure** that converts one CEFR can-do target into a short, gamified, mobile lesson — through a fixed pedagogical cycle, filled with per-language data, and checked against the CEFR competences and modes. It is the **how**, distinct from the standard, the content, and the product.

2.1 The four-layer model

Layer	Name	Question it answers
Standard	CEFR (Council of Europe)	*What* to learn, and *how far* (A1→C2 can-do targets)
Method	**MLLDE** — this document	*How* to turn any target into a lesson
Data	Per-language content	*Which* words, chunks, grammar, functions, culture
Product	Language Passport	The *first thing built* with the method

CEFR gives the destination; the language data is the cargo; MLLDE is the repeatable vehicle that gets any learner there, in any language.

2.2 What MLLDE is NOT

- **Not the app (Language Passport).** The app is the first product; the method could produce many others.
- **Not CEFR.** CEFR is the standard it plugs into; MLLDE adds no levels — it delivers them.
- **Not the language content.** Words, grammar and culture are swappable data; MLLDE is language-agnostic.
- **Not a single approach or theory.** It orchestrates several frameworks; the originality is the synthesis.

- **Not a grammar checker or an AI.** The rules, the grammar book and Grace are components inside the method.
- **Not a fixed set of lessons.** Barcelona and Sevilla are instances; the method generates lessons.
- **Not a syllabus or textbook.** It is a generative procedure, not static content.
- **Not a technology or platform.** The PWA is today's delivery; the engine-plus-data idea is portable.
- **Not a certification body.** It aligns to CEFR but issues no diplomas; it gates mastery within a lesson.

Boundary in one line: *MLLDE is not the standard, not the content, not the product, not any one theory, and not the technology — it is the method that binds a CEFR target, a language's data, and a synthesis of frameworks into a replicable, playable mobile lesson.*

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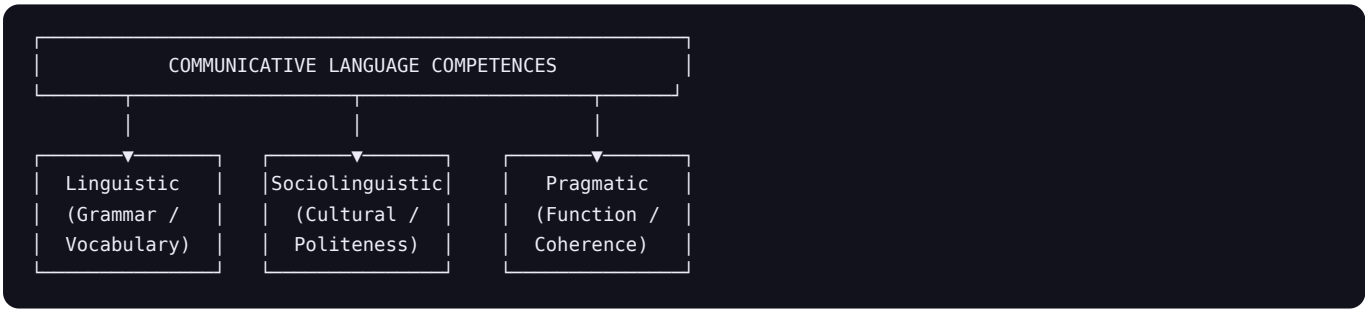
3. The CEFR competence core

The **CEFR** (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages), developed by the **Council of Europe**, replaces the traditional four skills with **four dynamic modes of communication**, powered by a core block of **three communicative language competences**. Every MLLDE lesson or level is specified against this core.

3.1 The four modes of communication

- **Reception** — receiving and processing spoken/written language without producing a new message (reading, listening).
- **Production** — constructing and delivering a continuous text to silent listeners/readers (a talk, an essay).
- **Interaction** — a joint exchange where parties alternate reception and production (conversation, debate, chat).
- **Mediation** — acting as a social agent to bridge people, texts or cultures (translate, summarise, explain across cultures).

3.2 The three communicative language competences



Competence	Covers	In MLLDE it lives in…
Linguistic	grammar, vocabulary, syntax, spelling	vocab, chunks, gap-fill, grammar (rules + book + Grace)
Sociolinguistic	register, politeness, cultural reference	culture & pragmatics cards; *nos pone...* vs *quiero*
Pragmatic	function, coherence, discourse	the mission (polite order); dialogue; reflection

3.3 Summary matrix — modes × competences

Mode	Linguistic	Sociolinguistic	Pragmatic
Reception	complex sentence syntax	regional accents / registers	overall tone & intent
Production	accurate vocabulary	adapt to a formal audience	structure with transitions
Interaction	correct verb tenses	conversational fillers	manage turn-taking
Mediation	translate precise terms	explain taboos across cultures	simplify a text into a summary

3.4 Level rule for the modes

Reception · Production · Interaction apply at every level from A1 upward. **Mediation** is introduced from **B2 onward (B2 · C1 · C2)**, where the learner can relay, explain and simplify a text or concept for someone else. *(CEFR defines simpler mediation at lower levels; MLLDE positions the mediation* mode *as an upper-level competence.)*

The four-word summary: competence = *what*; mode = *how it is used*; level = *how far*; MLLDE = *the method*.

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4. The international standard and the language data base

Two source families anchor the curriculum: the **universal standard** (CEFR — Council of Europe) and, for each language, that language's **official CEFR-aligned content reference** — for Spanish, the *Plan curricular del Instituto Cervantes*.

4.1 The standard — CEFR (Council of Europe)

The **CEFR** (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages) is the standard of the **Council of Europe**. It grew out of decades of work — it *"did not suddenly appear from nowhere in 2001, but was a development over a period of time"* — that offered a fresh way of communicating teaching aims, more conducive to the **operational appropriation of an unfamiliar language**: by identifying real language needs, it pinpointed the knowledge and know-how required to reach a communicative **"threshold."** The CEFR organises proficiency into **six levels, A1–C2**, regrouped into three broad bands — **Basic User (A1–A2)**, **Independent User (B1–B2)** and **Proficient User (C1–C2)** — which local contexts may further subdivide. Every level is defined through **"can-do" descriptors.**

> **Council of Europe — CEFR level descriptions:** https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/level-descriptions

4.2 The Spanish content standard — Plan curricular del Instituto Cervantes

MLLDE anchors the **method** to CEFR (universal), which is what makes it language-agnostic. The **content** for a given language is drawn from that language's official, CEFR-aligned reference. **For Spanish, Language Passport uses the *Plan curricular del Instituto Cervantes*** — the curriculum of the **Instituto Cervantes**, the official institution for the teaching of Spanish — to **unify its programmatic content** (Gramática, Funciones, Nociones…). *(For another language, its own official CEFR-aligned reference would be used.)*

> **Plan curricular del Instituto Cervantes:**
> https://cvc.cervantes.es/ensenanza/biblioteca_ele/plan_curricular/default.htm

4.3 Sources held (`docs/sources/`)

Source	Feeds	Levels
CEFR Descriptors 2020 (EN/FR/DE/IT/ES)	the standard — levels + 4 modes (~1,832 can-do)	Pre-A1 → C2
CVC *Plan curricular* — Gramática (Glosario + Inventarios)	**Linguistic** competence (forms)	A1-A2 · B1-B2 · C1-C2
CVC *Plan curricular* — Funciones (Inventarios)	**Pragmatic** competence (functions) → Interaction	A1-A2 · B1-B2 · C1-C2

Still to add for full Spanish coverage: Nociones (vocabulary → Linguistic); Saberes y comportamientos socioculturales + Referentes culturales (→ Sociolinguistic); Tácticas y estrategias pragmáticas + Géneros discursivos (→ Pragmatic/discourse); Pronunciación y Ortografía (→ Linguistic).

4.4 Copyright & citation

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5. The MLLDE design procedure

5.1 Input contract

Every lesson begins from a **CEFR level + a can-do descriptor + a real-world scenario**. Example: A2 · "Can order a meal" (scale: *Obtaining goods and services*) · scenario: a Barcelona tapas bar.

5.2 Build process — SAM

Lessons are produced through the **Successive Approximation Model (SAM)**: a preparation phase, an iterative design "savvy start", then iterative build cycles — prototype, review, refine. This is why MLLDE is a *method* (a repeatable process), not a one-off artefact.

5.3 Frameworks synthesised (credited)

Framework	Contribution to MLLDE
SAM (Allen & Sites, 2012)	the iterative build process
G-CLIL / IPO (Casañ-Pitarch, 2017)	the gamified Input–Processing–Output cycle
CLIL 4Cs (Coyle, 2007/2010)	Content · Communication · Cognition · Culture
ESA (Harmer, 2007)	Engage–Study–Activate staging
CTL / REACT (Johnson, 2002; CORD/Crawford, 2001)	contextual, authentic tasks
Lexical Approach (Lewis, 1993)	teaching in chunks
Dual-coding / multimedia (Mayer, 2009)	animated, image-supported vocabulary
Interlanguage pragmatics (Kasper & Rose, 2001)	the register / politeness cards
Mobile Learning Design (Clothier, 2026)	short, one-handed mobile delivery
CEFR (Council of Europe, 2020)	the leveling & competence standard

5.4 How the frameworks map to the lesson cycle

§5.3 lists the frameworks (the *theory*); §6.2 shows *where each one fires* as the learner moves through a lesson. This crosswalk links the two. Four elements are **cross-cutting** — they shape every step rather than sitting in one row: **SAM** (the build process), **Mobile Learning Design** (the delivery), **CEFR** (the level & mode/competence targets) and the **Plan curricular · Instituto Cervantes** (the Spanish content).

Lesson step (mode)	Framework(s) it operationalises
Whole arc (IPO)	G-CLIL / IPO (Casañ-Pitarch); ESA (Harmer); CLIL 4Cs (Coyle) across all
Arrival — hook/objective	ESA "Engage"; CTL meaningful connection
Vocabulary (animated) — *Reception*	Dual-coding/multimedia (Mayer); Lexical Approach (Lewis); IPO *Input*
Chunks — *Reception/Production*	Lexical Approach (Lewis); functional chunks → pragmatics (Kasper & Rose)
Model dialogue — *Reception*	IPO *Input*; CLIL *Communication*; register → pragmatics (Kasper & Rose)
Gap-fill — *Processing*	IPO *Processing*; ESA "Study→Activate" bridge
Mission — *Interaction*	CTL / REACT (authentic task); ESA "Activate"; IPO *Output*; pragmatics; G-CLIL gamification

Lesson step (mode)	Framework(s) it operationalises
Reflection (Speak/Write) — *Production*	IPO *Output*; REACT "Transferring"; CTL self-regulated learning
Culture & pragmatics cards	CLIL 4Cs *Culture*; pragmatics (Kasper & Rose)
Rewards	G-CLIL gamification ring (Casañ-Pitarch); motivation

In one line: §5.3 is *what MLLDE is made of*; §6.2 is *where each of those things fires* — and CEFR is the ruler every step is measured against.

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6. The lesson blueprint

6.1 Engine + data (the Destination Schema)

The lesson cycle is a **shared engine**; a lesson is a **data object** (the Destination Schema). Building a new lesson — or a whole new language — is *filling in data*, not rewriting logic. That is the method's core innovation and the reason it is replicable across languages.

6.2 The lesson cycle (IPO) mapped to modes & competences

Step	Mode	Competence
Arrival (hook, objective)	—	sets the scenario
Vocabulary (animated)	Reception	Linguistic
Chunks	Reception / Production	Linguistic + Pragmatic
Model dialogue	Reception	Linguistic + Sociolinguistic
Gap-fill	Processing	Linguistic (formative)
Mission (authentic assessment)	**Interaction**	Pragmatic + Sociolinguistic
Immediate Assessment — "Don't give up!" (Speak / Write) ★	**Production**	all three
Culture & pragmatics cards	—	Sociolinguistic
Rewards	—	motivation

★ Mandatory step (see §8.1). The output/transfer step is delivered with the **Immediate Assessment** standard and is labelled **"Don't give up!"** (encouraging, never "fail"). It is a required component of *every* lesson.

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7. Lesson / level planning template (standing rule)

Every lesson or level plan must fill this before anything is built. It guarantees CEFR alignment and international comparability.

Header: language · CEFR level (Pre-A1…C2) · scenario/destination · target can-do descriptor(s).

Mode	What this lesson does (fill)	Applies at
Reception	listening + reading targets	A1+
Production	spoken + written monologue targets	A1+
Interaction	spoken + written exchange targets	A1+
Mediation	relay / explain / simplify a text or concept	**B2+**

Competences block (fill for each): Linguistic (vocabulary · chunks · grammar points); Sociolinguistic (register · politeness · culture); Pragmatic (functions · discourse · coherence).

Mandatory components (every lesson, non-negotiable): an authentic-assessment **Mission** (§6.2) and the **Immediate Assessment — "Don't give up!"** output step with its non-punitive feedback + retry + **Ask-Grace** escalation (§8.1). A plan is not complete unless both are present.

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8. Assessment, feedback and motivation

- **Authentic assessment.** A real-world mission is the gate — mastery, not a score (CTL).
- **Feedback ladder.** Offline rules (spelling, agreement, missing auxiliary) → the grammar book (deep-linked) → **Grace**, the AI mentor, for open-ended correction.
- **Motivation.** A global wallet (coins, passport stamps, souvenirs), a rank path (Hitchhiker → Travel Ambassador) and a world-tour map.

8.1 Immediate Assessment — mandatory design standard

Every city/lesson — already built or to be developed — must implement the Immediate Assessment component at the output/transfer step. It is inherited from the shared engine, so existing destinations (Barcelona, Sevilla) already comply; any new destination inherits it automatically and **must not** remove or weaken it.

Required behaviour

1. **Two output modes.** The learner chooses 🎙️ **Speak** or ✍️ **Write** to deploy the language in a new context (REACT — transfer; Crawford/CORD, 2001).
2. **Instant, specific check** of the learner's production against the lesson data: vocabulary (incl. wrong-language/English words), spelling (edit-distance near-miss), known grammar confusions, and required auxiliaries — plus a minimum-length / target-word gate.
3. **Non-punitive feedback.** Errors are shown in **warm amber with a 🤔 "not sure" icon — never red** (red discourages learners). Feedback is **specific** (says *what* and *why*, with a short example) and **bilingual** (target-language first, brief English gloss).
4. **Retry, always.** The learner is invited to fix it and try again — unlimited, encouraging attempts; success is celebrated (coins + stamp).
5. **Escalation to the AI mentor (mandatory button).** Every non-success state shows a "🌊 **Pregúntale a Grace — explica y corrige**" button that hands the learner's sentence + the flagged mistake to **Grace TOP** for an open-ended grammar/vocabulary explanation.
6. **Encouraging label.** The step is titled **"Don't give up!"** (not "Reflexión"/"fail").

Pedagogical basis. Formative assessment / feedback-for-learning; mastery-learning retry; affective-filter reduction (non-punitive colour + tone); REACT *Transferring*; CTL authentic, low-stakes assessment. This is the MLLDE realisation of *assessment as learning*, not *of* learning.

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9. Language Passport — curriculum so far

Language Passport is Project 1 of MLLDE: a gamified, offline-capable mobile app teaching Spanish for travellers. Two destinations are built (Barcelona, Sevilla), both CEFR A1–A2. Each is specified below by **mode × competence × level**, with the CVC *Plan curricular* items it realises.

9.1 Barcelona — "De Tapas Por La Rambla"

- **Scenario:** ordering food & drinks at a tapas bar · **CEFR level:** A1–A2 · **Language:** Spanish
- **CEFR scale / descriptors:** *Obtaining goods and services* — A1 "Can ask for food and drink using basic expressions"; A2 "Can order a meal." Reflection: *Sustained monologue — describing experience* (A1–A2).
- **Modes:** Reception (model dialogue) · Production (reflection: Speak/Write) · Interaction (the ordering mission). Mediation: not at A1–A2.

Competence	CVC *Plan curricular* items realised
Pragmatic (Funciones)	4.3 Pedir objetos · 4.2 Pedir un favor · 4.14 Ofrecer e invitar · 1.2 Pedir información / 1.3 Dar información · 3.2 Expresar gustos e intereses
Linguistic (Gramática)	1. El sustantivo (género y número — *patatas/bravas* concordancia) · 2. El adjetivo (concordancia) · 3. El artículo (*unas/las*) · 9. El verbo (presente; pretérito perfecto *he comido*, A2)
Sociolinguistic	5.1 Saludar / 5.2 Responder a un saludo · 5.12 Agradecer · register: *nos pone... / ¿me pone...?* vs *quiero*

Content: Vocabulary — las patatas bravas, la tortilla española, una cervecilla, los pinchos, el agua, la cuenta. Chunks — *¿me pone...?, nos pone..., por favor, ¿y para beber?* Mission — order ≥2 tapas + ≥2 drinks politely. Culture — La Rambla, Miró, La Boquería, *"nos pone..., not quiero."* Reward — Barcelona stamp; souvenirs.

9.2 Sevilla — "De Bares por Santa Cruz"

- **Scenario:** ordering tapas & drinks in an Andalusian bar · **CEFR level:** A1–A2 · **Language:** Spanish
- **CEFR scale / descriptors:** *Obtaining goods and services* (as above); adds asking for a recommendation and expressing preference.
- **Modes:** Reception · Production · Interaction. Mediation: not at A1–A2.

Competence	CVC *Plan curricular* items realised
Pragmatic (Funciones)	4.3 Pedir objetos · 4.14 Ofrecer e invitar · 2.1 Pedir opinión / recomendación · 3.4 Preguntar por preferencias / 3.5 Expresar preferencia · 1.2 / 1.3 Pedir / Dar información
Linguistic (Gramática)	1. El sustantivo · 2. El adjetivo · 3. El artículo · 9. El verbo (presente); *tinto de verano* — preposición *de* (sintagma nominal)
Sociolinguistic	5.1 Saludar / 5.2 Responder · 5.12 Agradecer · register: *una caña* (local usage) vs *una cerveza*

Content: Vocabulary — el salmorejo, el pescaíto frito, una caña, un tinto de verano, la tapa, la cuenta. Chunks — *¿me pone...?, para mí..., ¿qué me recomienda?, por favor.* Mission — order ≥2 tapas + ≥2 drinks politely. Culture — La Giralda, orange trees, salmorejo vs gazpacho, *"una caña."* Reward — Sevilla stamp; souvenirs.

9.3 Roadmap

- **Levels:** current lessons target A1–A2; the framework scales to B1–B2 and C1–C2 using the same CVC inventories. Mediation tasks enter at **B2**.
- **Destinations:** Europe · España live (Barcelona, Sevilla); Africa · Asia · America · Oceania locked ("próximamente").
- **Languages:** the method is language-agnostic — the same A2 "order a meal" target can generate a French *café* or German *Biergarten* lesson from that language's data.

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10. Sources and intellectual property

10.1 References (APA 7th)

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Note. Casañ-Pitarch (2017) and Clothier (2026, forthcoming) details should be verified against the source copies.

10.2 Intellectual property

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